

closely related. Be it RGB channels or CMYK channels, when each channel is isolated, there are lighter and darker areas in each of them. In any channel, there are grey as well as white areas. The white areas indicate that there is maximum red content in that particular region of the image. Similarly, the black areas indicate that there is no red content in that particular region of the image. Alpha channels are similar—the difference being that instead of corresponding to colour, alpha channels correspond to variations in transparency. Therefore, white areas correspond to absolute transparency while black areas correspond to opacity in the specific regions of the image.

So what is the advantage of using masks? Well, it is better to have no-so-important information hidden, rather than no having information that could be required any moment. Put in a simpler way—it is wiser to hide the birds and a few stray animals in the backdrop of scenery that does not seem appealing, rather than using an image that doesn't have any of these elements. It is easier to hide, rather than create birds and animals to improve the image.

3.3 Layer Blending Modes

Layer blending refers to the extent the overlapping layers interact with each other to yield the broader final picture. So say you have a layer containing the image of a lady, while on the second layer you have the image of a fish, you can easily create the effect of a mermaid by reducing the opacity of both layers, towards the middle. Effectively, the two layers merge towards the centre.

Tutorial for layer blending modes

There is a pop-up menu on the Layers Palette, generally untouched by newbies to Photoshop—terms such as Multiply and Screen do sound unconventional with images—but as you go about playing with Photoshop, you see how they fit together.